Beyond the Border

Designing Media Participation for the Monash Computer History Museum

THE SEMIOTICS, MEDIATISATION & CULTURE

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Research Area

This research explores how mediatisation reshapes the visibility and engagement of university museums. Using the Monash Computer History Museum as a case study, it examines how digital media, spatial communication, and participatory design can transform a traditional exhibition into a dynamic, interactive learning environment. By analysing how students engage with digital and physical interfaces, the study investigates strategies to increase awareness, accessibility, and cultural relevance within a media-saturated campus context.

Problem Statement

Despite being located in a central study area of Building B, the Monash Computer History Museum remains largely unnoticed by students. Its conventional display format, static signage, and limited digital presence restrict both visibility and participation. The museum currently functions as an archive rather than an interactive communication space. This research addresses the question: How can mediatisation help the museum transition from a traditional exhibition to a participatory, media-integrated environment? The study identifies barriers to awareness, examines how students perceive digital interaction, and explores how mediated storytelling can reconnect the museum with its university community.

Methods

A mixed-methods approach was adopted, combining site observation, semi-structured interviews, surveys, and prototype testing. Observation and spatial mapping documented the museum's visual accessibility and visitor flow. Interviews explored students' awareness and expectations, while a campus-wide survey (n=34) gathered insights into digital engagement preferences. A low-fidelity AR guidebook prototype was later tested through think-aloud sessions to evaluate participatory interaction and media responsiveness, integrating both qualitative and quantitative feedback.

Results & Findings

The investigation revealed four major challenges: poor visibility, lack of communication, passive engagement, and the absence of digital mediation. Most students were unaware of the museum's existence, or mistook it for a row of display cabinets rather than a public exhibition. In the final prototype test, participants responded positively to interactive media, noting that the experience significantly increased curiosity and memory retention even within the existing site. The study shows that mediatisation does not enhance engagement through more technology, but through meaningful connections between space, story, and audience that restore visibility and relevance.

Future Research

Future research will build on the current AR guidebook by developing planned extensions around the campus. Based on survey findings about how students access information, poster and signage designs will be introduced to promote the AR experience and guide participation. The project also aims to expand the AR content itself, creating opportunities for students to engage more directly with the museum and contribute to its mediated storytelling and community visibility.

Self-Reflection

Through this project, I realised that mediatisation is not only technical but deeply relational—it connects people, space, and meaning. From the interviews and prototype work, I found that adding more technology does not necessarily make an experience smoother or more engaging. I also believe that using an AR guidebook as a transitional renewal offers a practical way for traditional museums to enhance participation and experience without major spatial change—a direction I hope to explore further.

Research Documentation

1.Introduction

The Monash Computer History Museum, located in Building B on the Caulfield campus, is a small but historically significant archive of computing technologies. Despite its location beside a busy study area, most students are unaware of its existence. The museum's static displays and lack of digital communication have led to low visibility and limited engagement. In a university that values media literacy and interactive learning, this raises the question of how heritage spaces can stay relevant in a media-driven environment.

This project investigates how the principles of mediatisation and participatory design can address this issue. Using qualitative research methods, including surveys and interviews, it explores students' awareness of the museum and their views on digital and interactive experiences. The findings aim to inform new communication strategies that help the museum connect with students and transition from a traditional exhibition to a mediatised, participatory museum.

2.Secondary Research

2.1. Mediatisation and the Contemporary Museum

Mediatisation explains how media changes the way people communicate and experience culture (Couldry and Hepp 2017). In museums, it means moving from showing objects to creating interactive and connected experiences. Drotner and Schrøder (2013) describe modern museums as media spaces where visitors learn and share knowledge through stories and technology. This idea is closely related to the challenge of the Monash Computer History Museum — it needs to shift from a quiet archive to a place of communication.

2.2 Visibility and Communication in University Spaces

Visibility, in the context of university environments, extends beyond physical access to include cognitive recognition and social relevance. Falk and Dierking (2016) argue that museum visibility depends on contextual learning—how audiences connect exhibits with personal experience. Similarly, McCarthy (2015) notes that digital signage and spatial communication are crucial in shaping awareness within campus spaces.

The Monash Computer History Museum exemplifies the consequences of limited media communication. Integrating communication design—such as posters, QR codes, and AR triggers—can reposition the museum within everyday campus media. Visibility thus becomes a communicative process rather than a structural one, linking the museum's cultural narrative to students' digital behaviour.

3.Research Methods

This project used a mixed-method design to understand how students perceive and engage with the Monash Computer History Museum. The methods included site observation, semi-structured interviews, a short online survey, and prototype testing.
These tools were chosen from Universal Methods of Design to collect both qualitative and quantitative data. Together, they provided a full picture of how students experience the museum—from what they see in daily life to how they react to new media ideas. Each method built on the previous one, gradually turning observations into design insights.

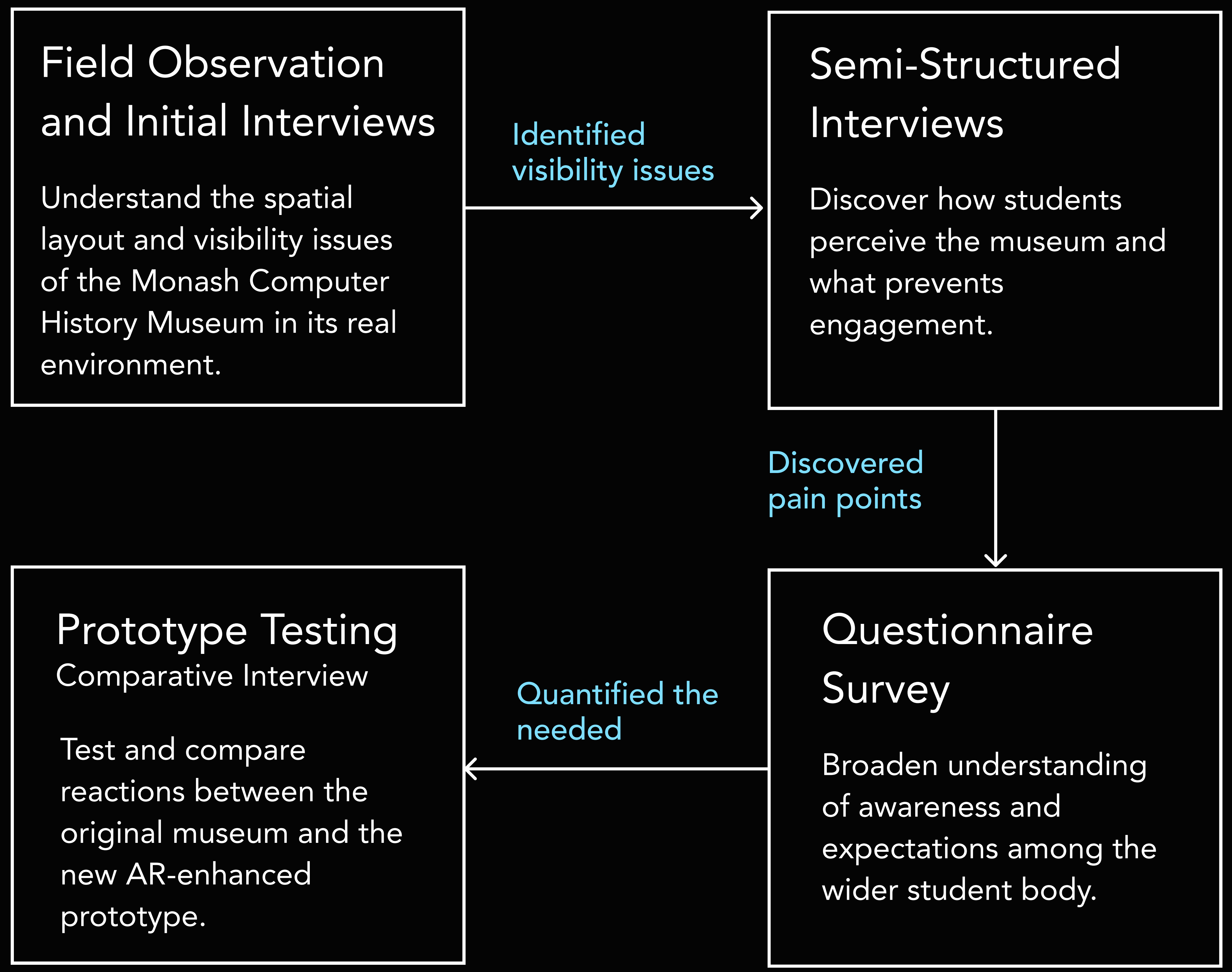


Figure 1. Method logic diagram

Phase	Method	Main Activities	Theoretical Foundation
Exploration	Field Investigation	Site observation and spatial mapping of the museum's entrance, lighting, and layout.	· Martin, Bella, and Bruce Hanington. Universal Methods of Design. 2012. "Field Study" & "Fly-on-the-Wall." · Sanders, Elizabeth B.-N., and Pieter Jan Stappers. 2012. Convivial Toolbox: Generative Research for the Front End of Design. BIS Publishers.
Insight	Semi-Structured Interviews	6 short interviews (4 students in the study area, 2 heritage students).	· Martin & Hanington. Universal Methods of Design (2012) – "Interview" method. · Brinkmann, Svend. 2014. "Unstructured and Semi-Structured Interviewing." In The Oxford Handbook of Qualitative Research, edited by Leavy. Oxford University Press.
Validation	Questionnaire Survey	Online survey distributed to campus students.	· Creswell, John W., and J. David Creswell. 2018. Research Design: Qualitative, Quantitative, and Mixed Methods Approaches. SAGE Publications. · Martin & Hanington (2012) – "Survey" & "Questionnaire."
Evaluation	Prototype Testing & Comparative Interview	One-on-one testing of the AR guidebook vs. the original museum experience.	· Norman, Donald A. 2013. The Design of Everyday Things. MIT Press.

Figure 2. Method summary and literature support

3.1 Field Investigation

The first stage of this research involved field investigation to understand the spatial and environmental conditions of the Monash Computer History Museum. This method allowed the researcher to observe how students move around the area, notice the museum's visibility, and experience the space as part of everyday campus life. Field investigation provides authentic insights into user behaviour and context that cannot be captured through secondary data alone (Martin and Hanington 2012).

3.1.1 Scanning, mapping and recording

During site visits, the Polycam app was used to create 3D scans of the interior environment and to conduct spatial mapping. These scans helped visualise how the museum connects—or fails to connect—with nearby circulation areas. A movement diagram was drawn to record students' walking paths and pauses around the museum zone. Observations were documented through notes, photos, and short videos to capture both physical layout and ambient atmosphere.

Polaroid 3D scanning :

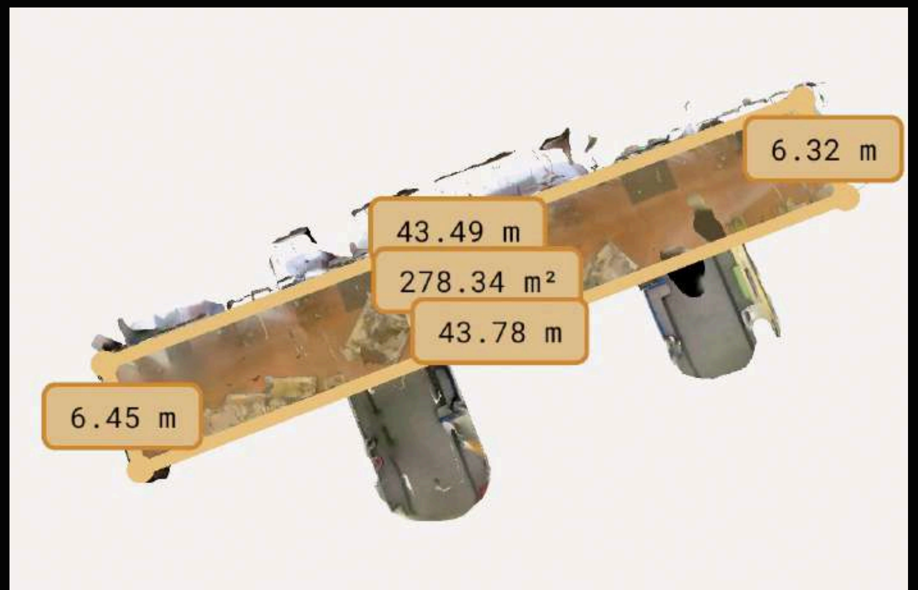


Figure 3. Overview of 3D scanning floor plan.

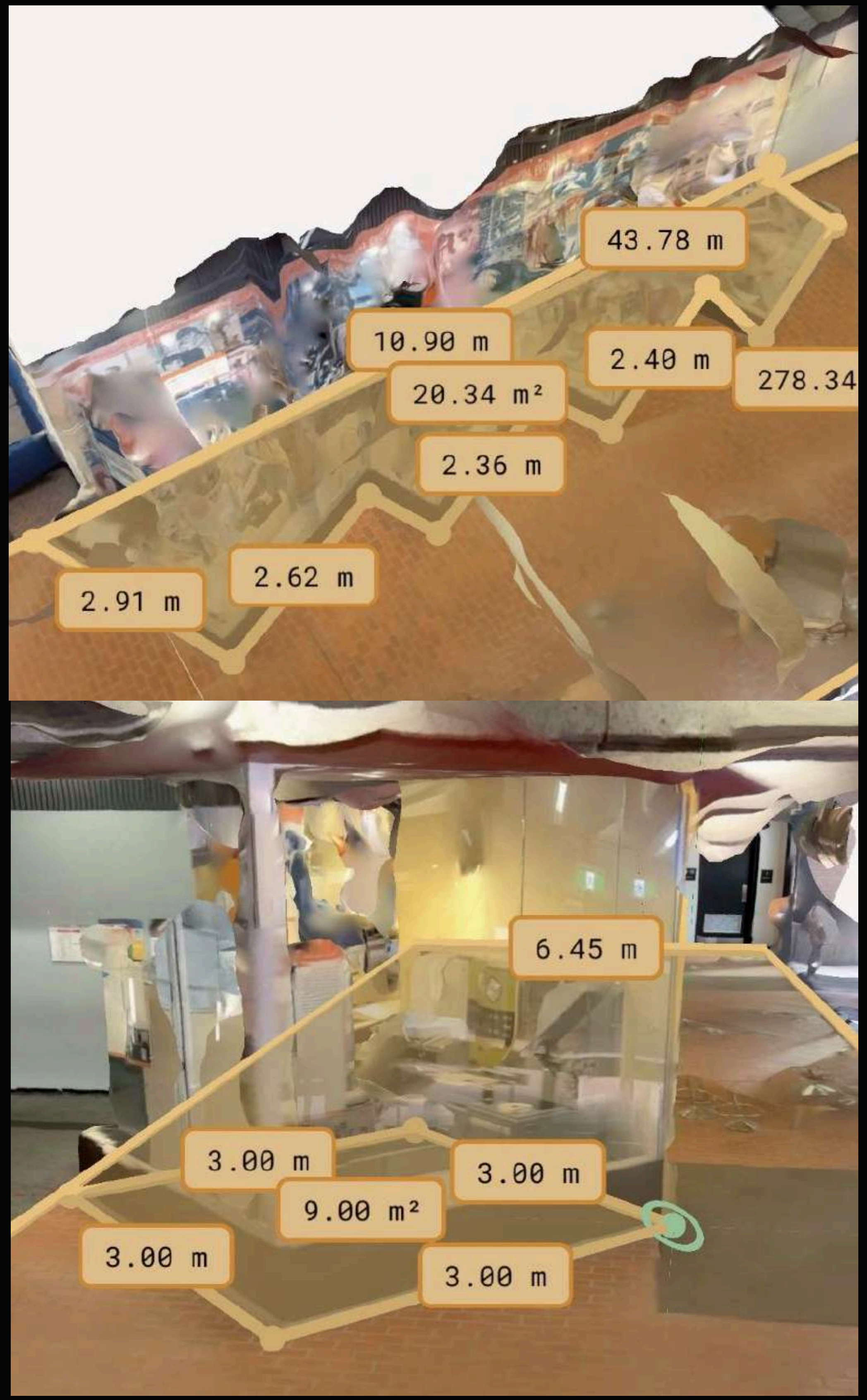


Figure 4. 3d scanning and measurement data

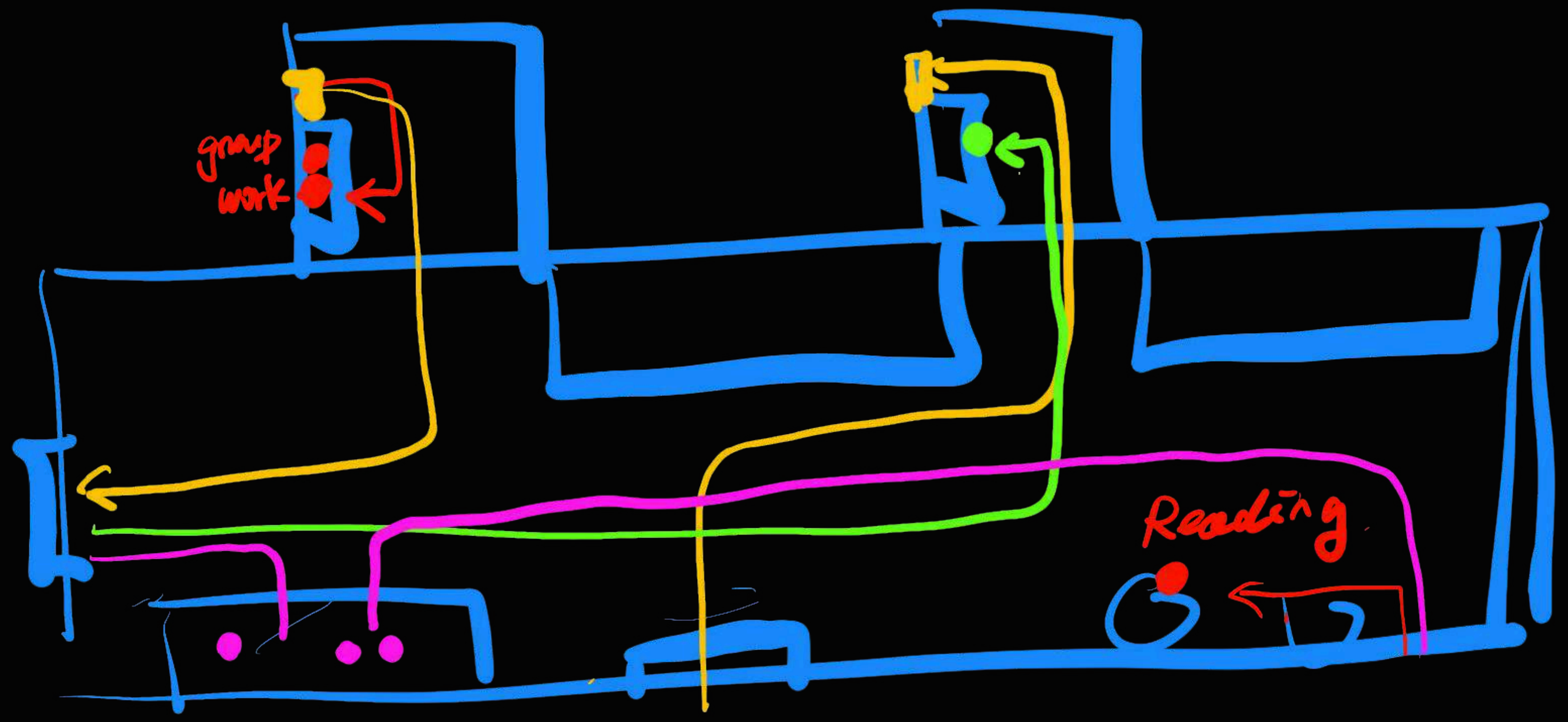


Figure 5. *Field survey record map*

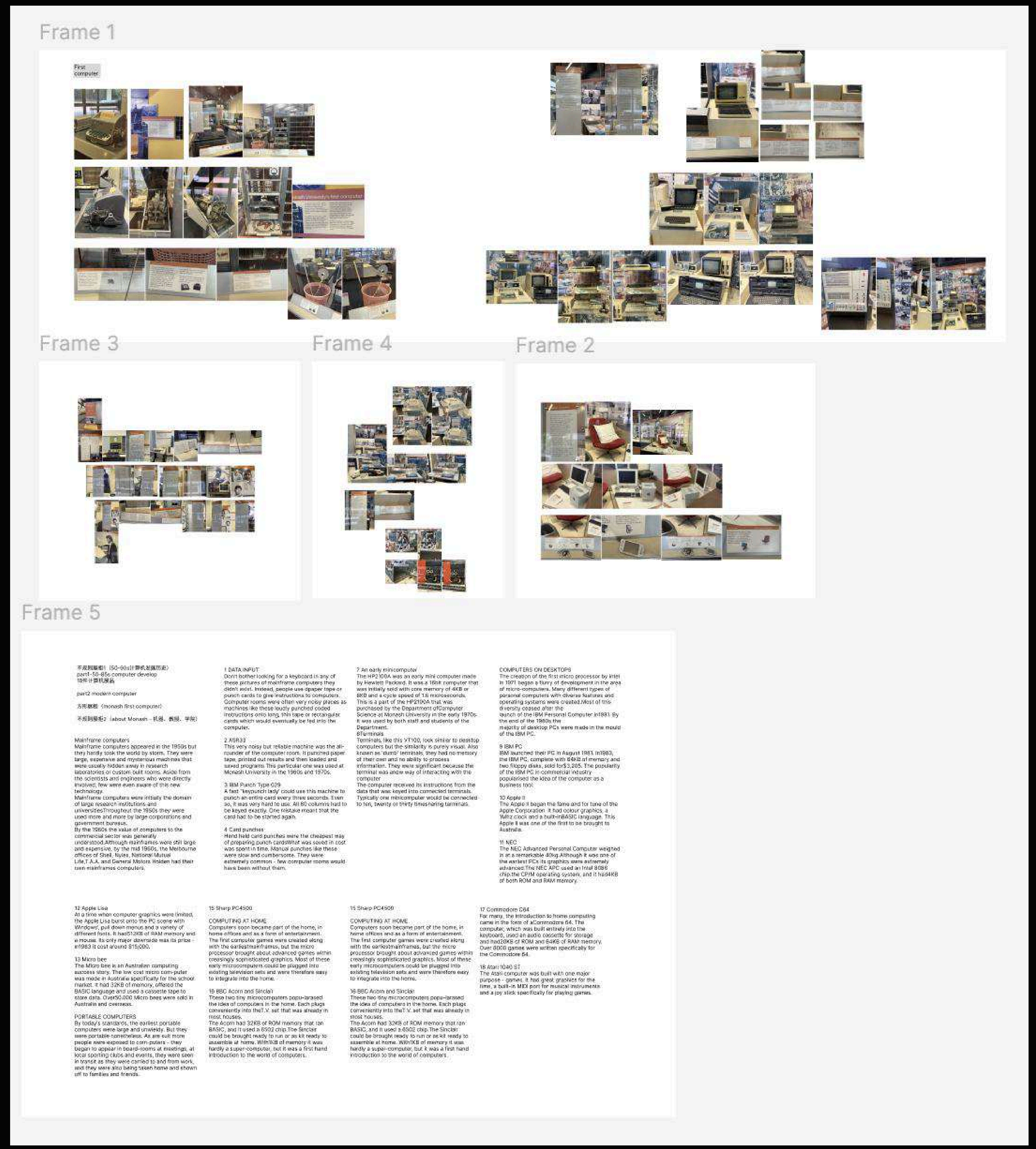


Figure 6. Exhibit collection Data

3.1.2 Exhibit collection

To better understand the Monash Computer History Museum, the existing exhibits were catalogued and grouped by type, period, and function. This process provided a clear overview of the museum's structure and revealed its main themes—from early computing hardware and storage devices to educational materials and interactive technologies.

The collected data became a useful reference for the prototype design, helping identify which artefacts could benefit from AR storytelling and how digital layers could enhance visitor engagement and understanding.

3.1.3 Research outcome

The results showed that the museum is visually hidden behind glass partitions and lacks clear signage or motion cues. Students studying in the nearby lounge often walked past without realising it was a museum. The surrounding study area felt bright and social, while the museum appeared closed, quiet, and isolated. These contrasts emphasised the spatial disconnection between the museum and its everyday environment.

In addition, a spatial distribution and movement diagram was created during the field observation to map how people moved through the area. This visual record helped identify where attention dropped and how circulation patterns contributed to the museum's invisibility within the campus flow.

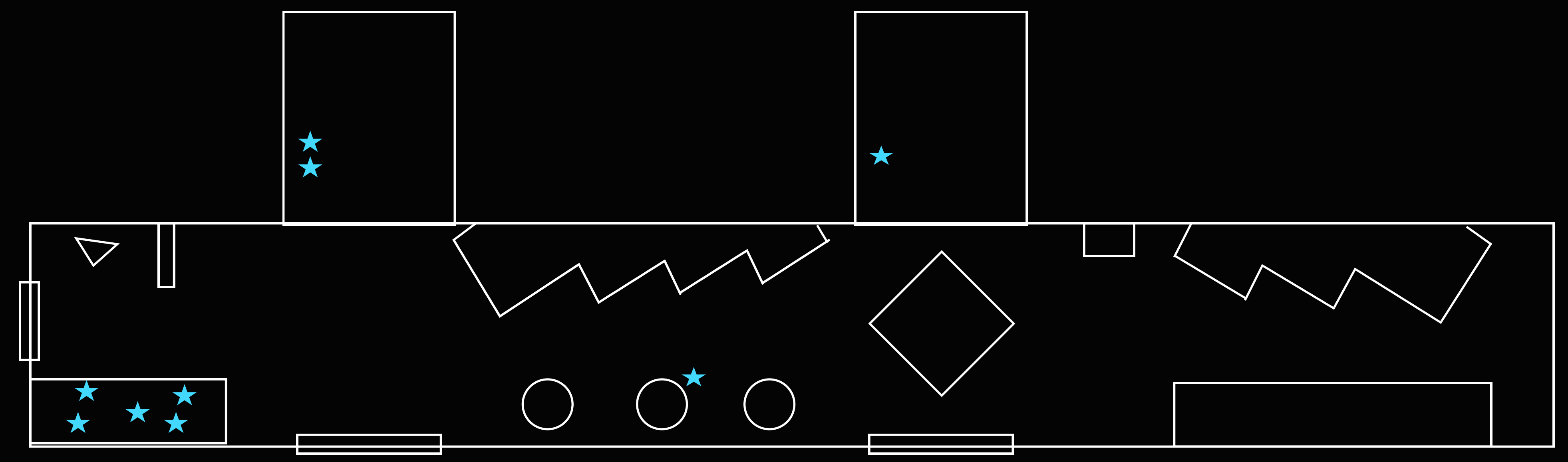


Figure 7. Analysis of population distribution map

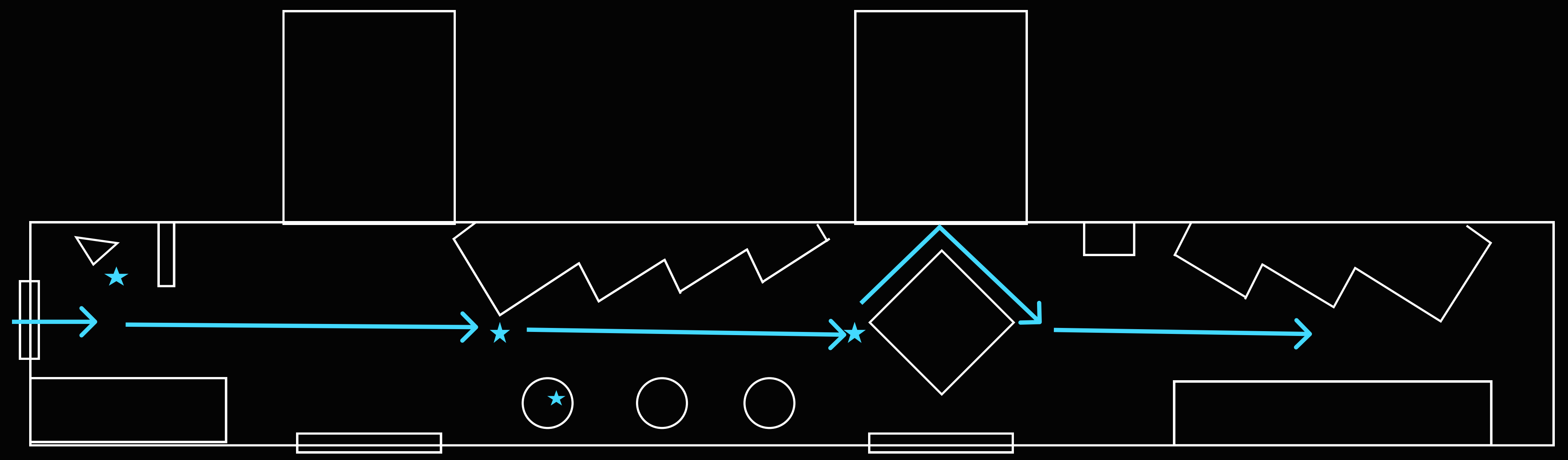


Figure 8. Museum floor plan and dynamic line analysis.

3.2 Semi-Structured Interviews

The second stage of the research used semi-structured interviews to explore how students perceive the Monash Computer History Museum and what prevents them from engaging with it. This method allowed open discussion guided by key questions, providing both structure and flexibility. Semi-structured interviews are useful for understanding personal attitudes, emotions, and experiences while still ensuring thematic consistency (Brinkmann 2014; Martin and Hanington 2012).

3.2.1 Interview basic situation

A total of 7 students participated in the interviews. Four were randomly approached in the nearby study area, while 3 were enrolled in a Cultural Heritage course that had previously discussed museum renewal. Each session lasted around 10–15 minutes and was conducted in a relaxed, conversational tone. Questions focused on:

- awareness of the museum's existence,
- their first impressions of the space,
- expectations for on-campus exhibitions, and
- attitudes toward digital or media-based interaction.

Section 1 – Awareness & First Impressions
(Purpose: To identify whether participants are aware of the museum and their initial associations with it.)
Q1: Why do you choose to study in this area instead of the library?
Q2: Where do you usually spend time in Building B? Have you ever noticed anything nearby that looks like a museum?
Q3: What comes to mind when you hear the term "Computer History Museum"?
Section 2 – Experience & Engagement
(Purpose: To understand current communication and engagement issues, and to identify the lack of mediatisation.)
Q4: Have you ever seen the exhibition content? If yes, what was your experience like?
Q5: Did you find the space inviting or easy to understand? Why or why not?
Q6: How do you usually find out about campus exhibitions or events? (e.g., posters, Instagram, Moodle, etc.)
Section 3 – Expectations & Media Preferences
(Purpose: To gather insights about students' expectations, media habits, and participatory potential.)
Q7: What would make you more likely to visit a campus museum like this?
Q8: How do you think digital media (such as screens, AR, or social media) could make the museum more engaging?
Q9: Would you be interested in contributing your own digital story or memory to a museum display?
Section 4 – Reflection
(Purpose: To explore students' deeper understanding of the cultural and educational role of university museums.)
Q10: In your opinion, what role should a university museum play for students today?

Figure 9. Semi-structured interview content

Theme Category	Method	Representative Quote
Visibility & Awareness	Most students were unaware of the museum’s existence; even those who passed by did not recognise its function,More people think it is a display cabinet.	“I didn’t know it was a museum—I thought it was just a display cabinet.”
Spatial Design & Invitation	The space feels closed and uninviting, with limited wayfinding cues. Glass cases create distance between the viewer and the exhibition.	“It feels like watching something behind glass, not being part of it.”
Content & Experience	Graphic design outdated and lack narrative coherence. Students struggled to connect artefacts to Monash’s computing heritage.	“The artefacts are valuable, but the storytelling is missing.”
Communication Channels	There is little to no online promotion. Students mainly rely on Instagram or faculty newsletters for event information.	“I’ve never seen the museum mentioned on Monash social media.”
Participatory Potential	Many students showed interest in contributing their own digital stories or projects, expressing a desire for co-creation opportunities.	“If students could design part of it, that would make it feel alive.”
Museum Role & Relevance	Students believe the museum should connect the university’s technological past with contemporary student culture, acting as a hub for learning and reflection.	“It should be a living cultural lab—a site for co-creation and reflection.”

Figure 10. Semi-structured interview content data

3.2.2 Interview information collection

The interviews show that the museum lacks visibility, clear communication, and engaging storytelling. Students often overlook it or see it as a closed display space. However, many expressed interest in more interactive and media-based experiences, hoping the museum could become a lively space that connects Monash’s technological history with today’s student culture.

3.2.3 Extended Investigation of Interview Findings

To further verify the interview findings on communication and visibility, a focused online search was conducted to examine how the Monash Computer History Museum appears across public and institutional platforms.

Detailed information was found only on the Monash University website, buried deep within a Faculty of IT subpage. On Google, the museum appears only through this page and a short entry in Victoria Collections, both difficult to find without specific keywords. There is no content on major social media platforms such as Instagram or Facebook.

These results confirm that the museum has very low digital visibility, explaining why most students are unaware of its existence.

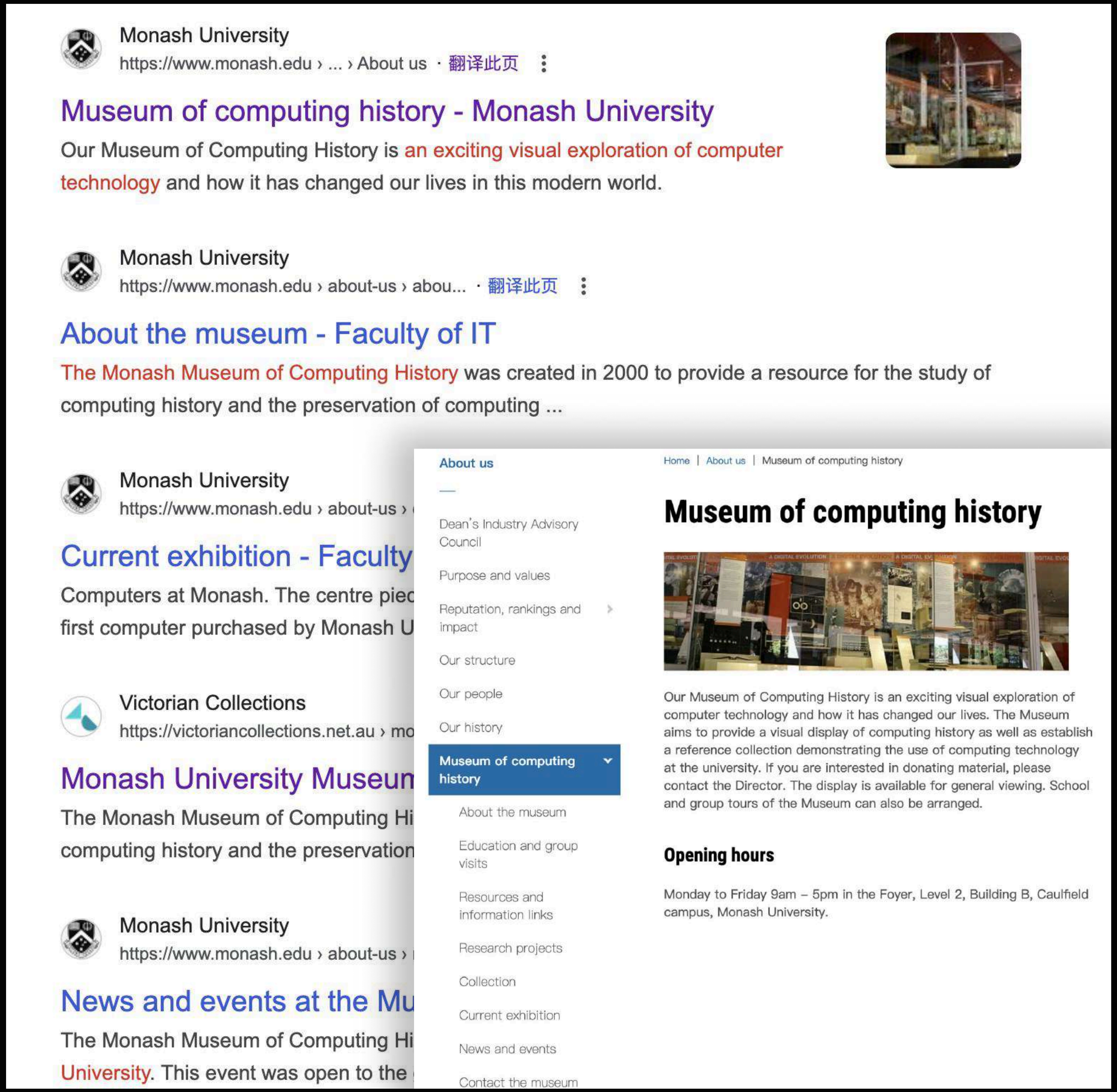


Figure 11. Google Web Search and the Official Website of Monash Museum

3.3 Questionnaire Survey

The third stage of the research conducted a questionnaire survey to validate and extend the insights gained from the interviews. As Creswell and Creswell (2018) note, surveys are effective for turning qualitative observations into measurable data. The questionnaire focused on the key issues identified earlier—low visibility, weak communication, and interest in digital interaction—to understand students' awareness and expectations.

Following Martin and Hanington (2012), this method helped confirm behavioural patterns across a broader group, providing quantitative evidence that supports the need for media-based engagement in the Monash Computer History Museum.

Scan to view
the complete questionnaire:

3.2.1 Interview basic situation

A total of 36 Monash University students participated in the questionnaire survey. The respondents represented a diverse range of disciplines, providing a broad perspective on how students from different fields perceive the Monash Computer History Museum. Among them, 16 students were from the Art, Design, and Architecture faculty, 12 students from Business and Economics, 2 students from the Faculty of Education, and 6 students from the Faculty of Information Technology.

The questionnaire was structured into three key sections: Awareness & First Impressions, Experience & Engagement, and Expectations & Media Preferences. Each section was designed to investigate different aspects of the student experience — from basic awareness of the museum, to their interaction habits, and their expectations for digital and participatory design.

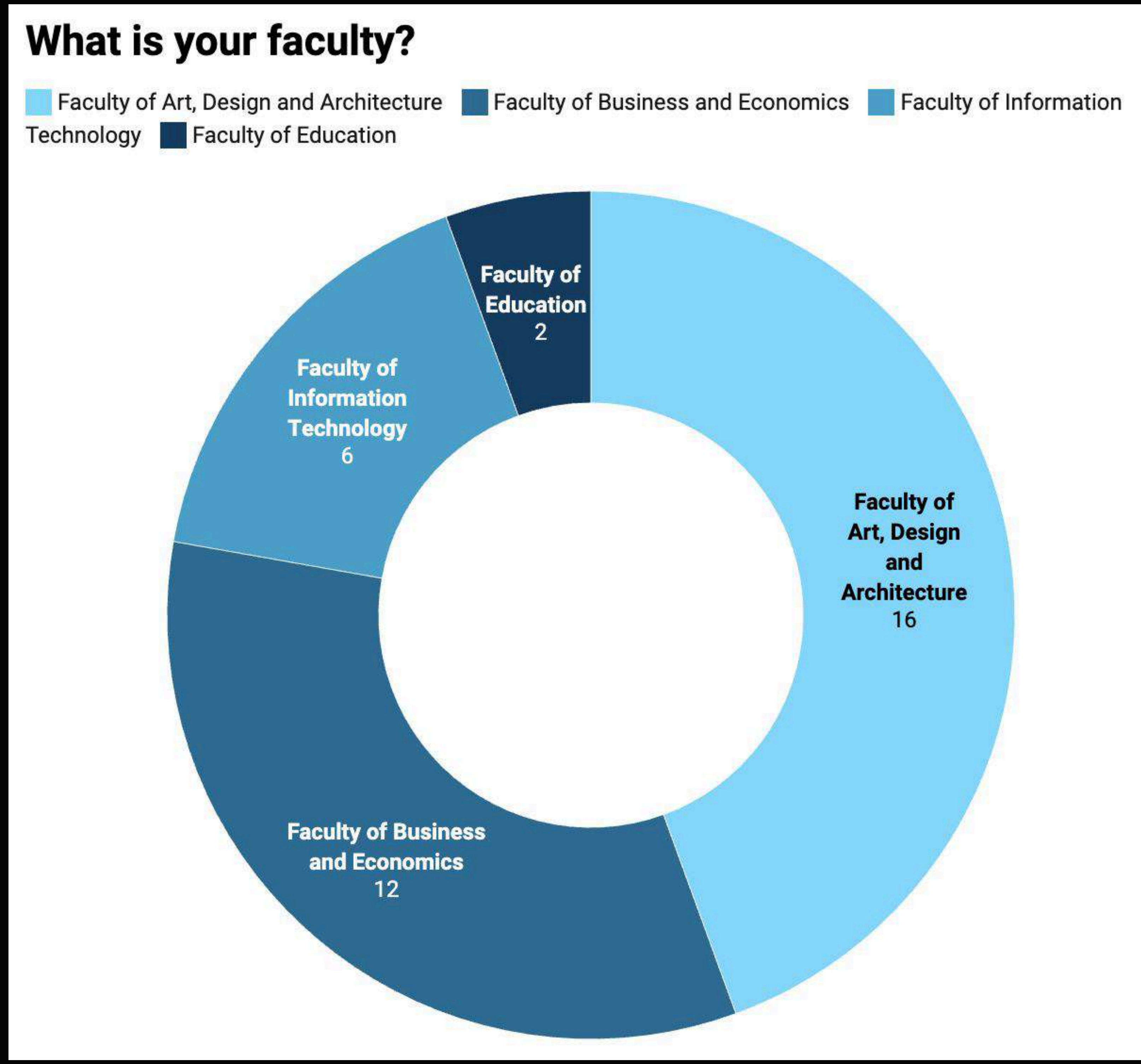
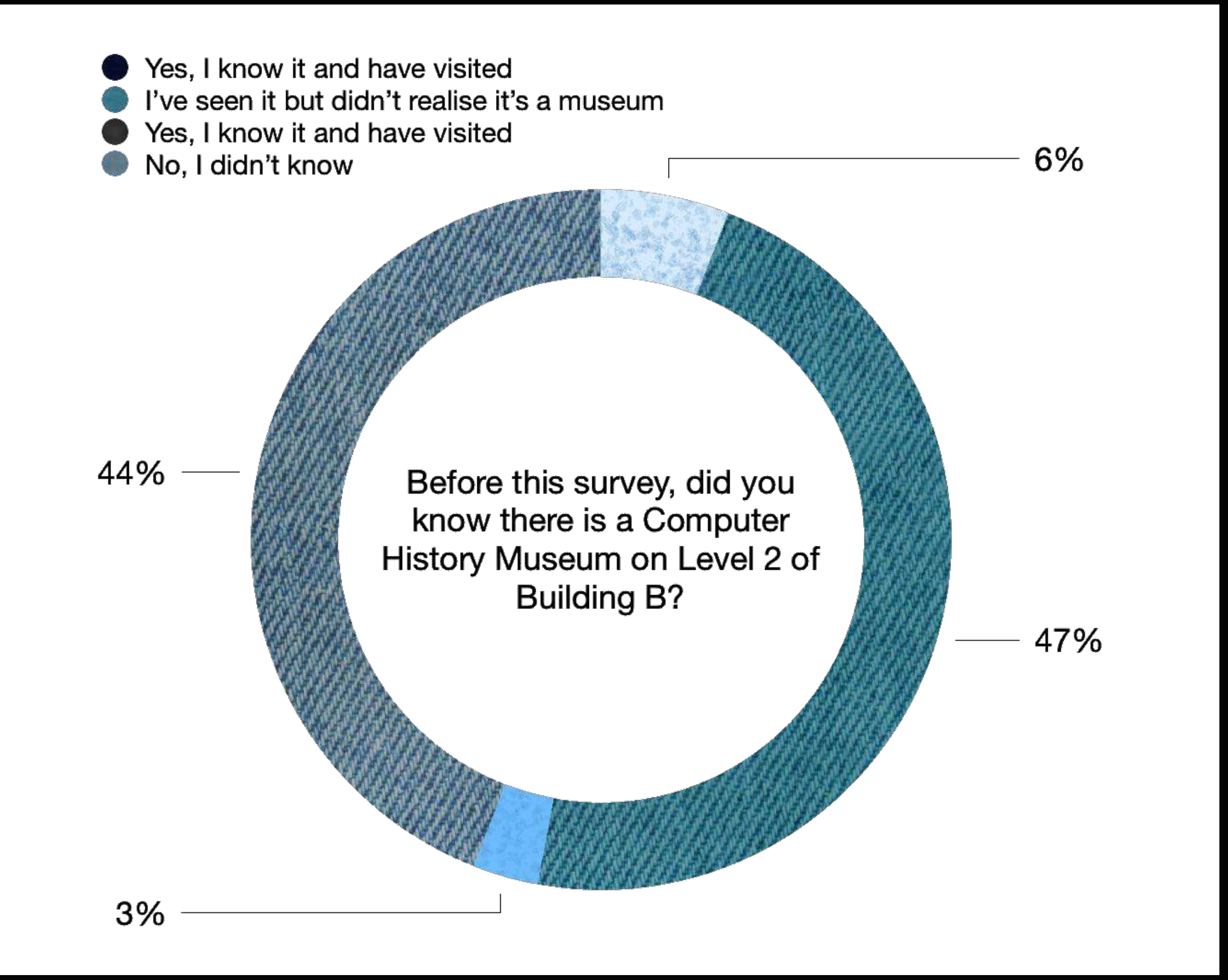


Figure 12. Part2 - Question 2, *Investigate the distribution of the population*

3.2.1 Data analysis

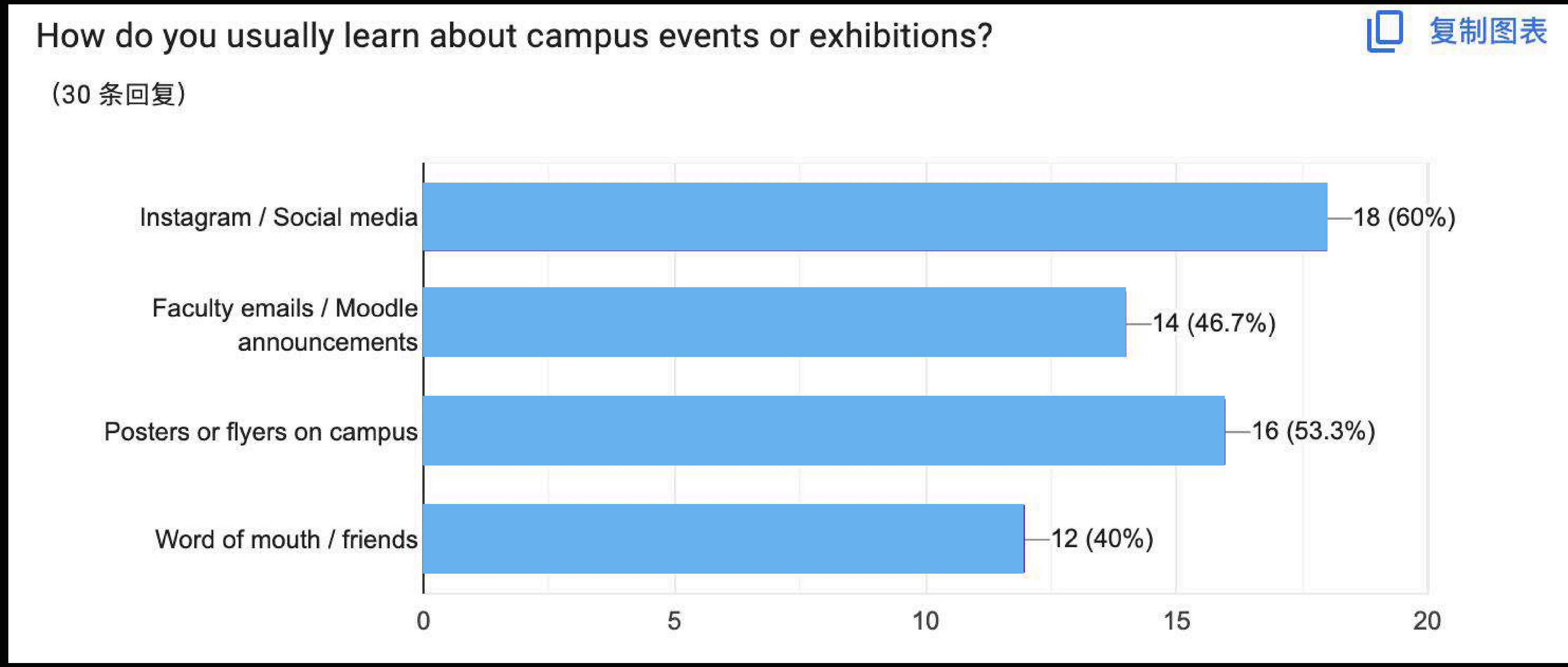
Awareness

The data show that over 80% of participants had never heard of or visited the museum. This result confirms the museum's low visibility and weak presence within the campus community. Most students mistook it for a display cabinet, indicating that its current location and lack of signage fail to communicate its identity as a public exhibition space.



Channels for Campus Information

Responses revealed a relatively balanced distribution of how students access campus event information, with social media platforms being the most frequently used source. This pattern suggests that future museum communication should focus on digital promotion and online visibility, integrating Instagram or student portals to reach the primary audience more effectively.



3.2.1 Data analysis - Preferred Forms of Mediatised Museum Experience

When asked which media approach would make a museum more engaging, participants provided varied responses; however, augmented reality (AR) was chosen by the majority. This result highlights a strong interest in interactive, technology-enhanced storytelling. It also directly informed the prototype development, establishing AR as the most promising medium to revitalise the museum experience and attract wider student participation.

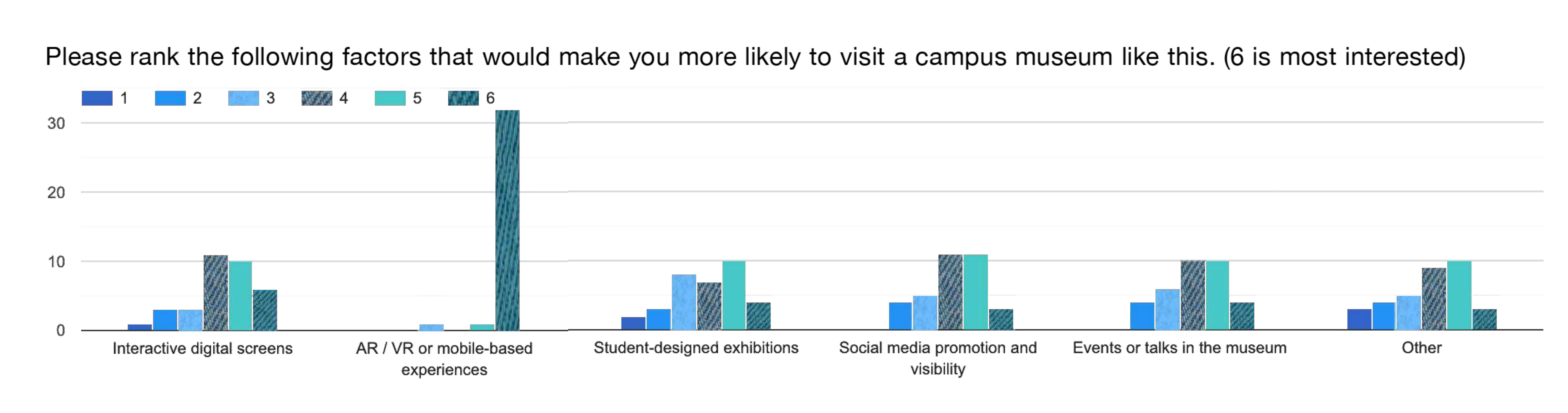


Figure 15. Part4 - Question 1, The survey of Student Awareness and Participation in the Monash Computer History Museum.

3.4 Prototype Testing

The final stage of the research involved prototype testing to evaluate how a low-fidelity AR guidebook could improve engagement with the Monash Computer History Museum. The prototype was designed to test how digital media could make the existing exhibition more visible, interactive, and emotionally engaging. Prototype testing allows designers to observe real user reactions and assess usability before final implementation (Martin and Hanington 2012; Norman 2013).

Figure 16. Prototype display

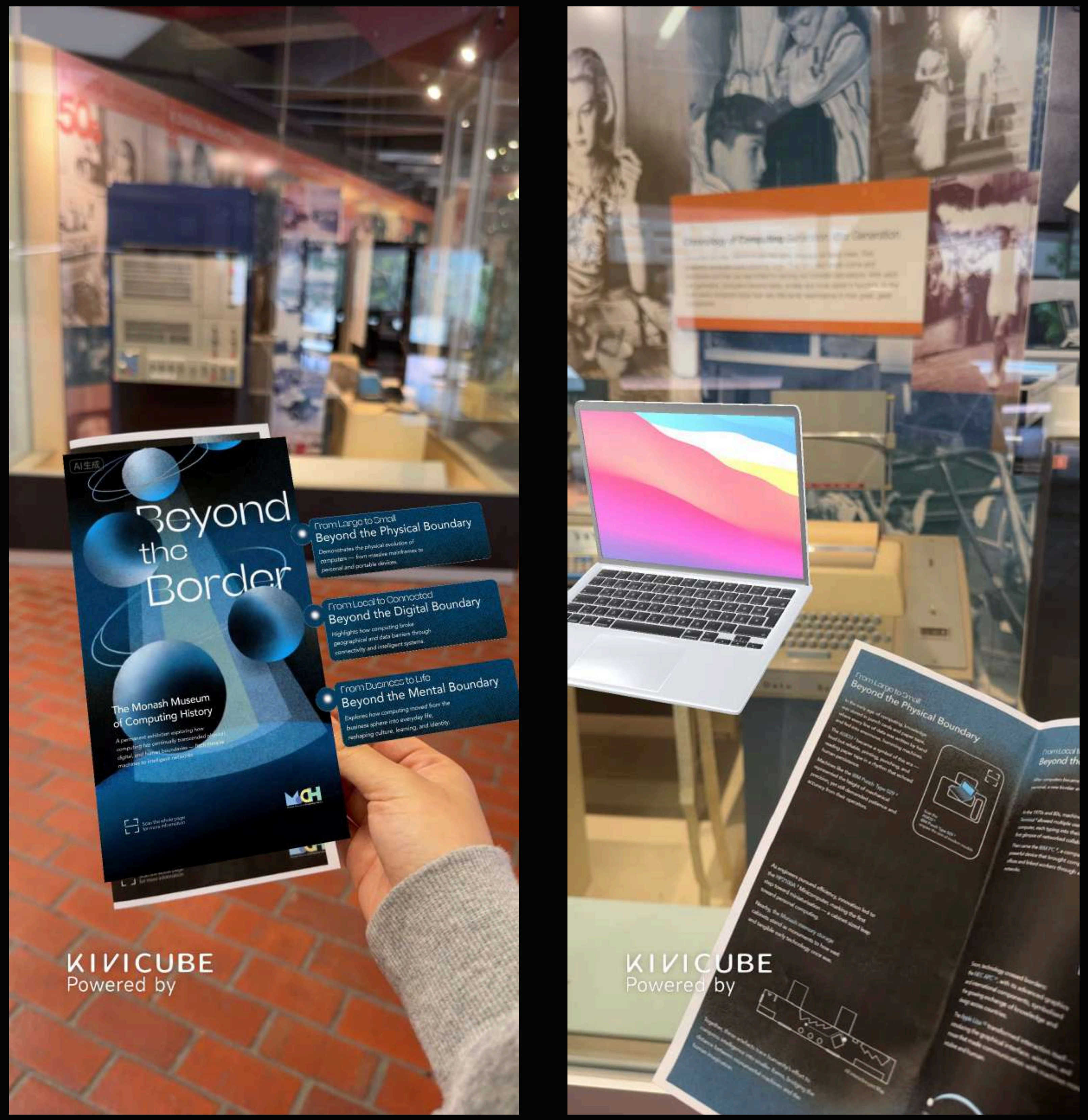


Figure 17. Prototype Testing in Museum

3.4.1 A think-aloud session

A think-aloud session was conducted with five participants to evaluate the prototype's usability and emotional engagement. Each participant explored both the existing museum display and the AR-enhanced version. They were asked to verbalise their thoughts while interacting with the prototype to reveal cognitive and emotional responses. To better capture participants' feelings, emoji stickers were used as a simple visual tool for recording emotions at different interaction points. This method helped to identify areas that evoked curiosity, confusion, or excitement.

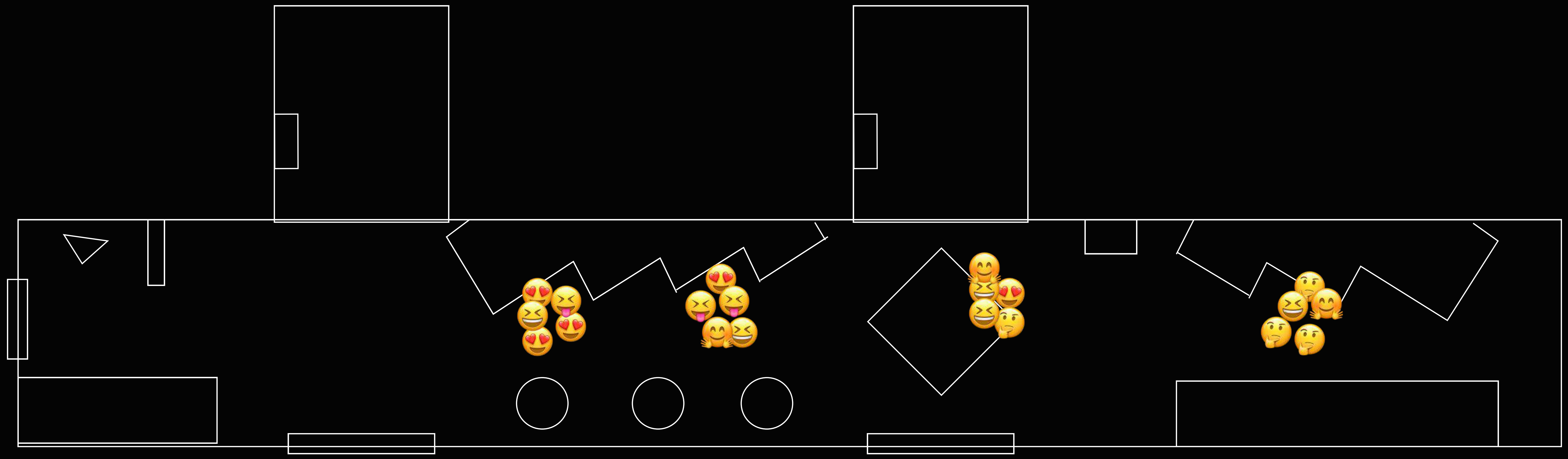


Figure 18. Interaction point feeling record

3.4.2 Summary of Prototype Testing Feedback

Participant	Key Reactions (Think-Aloud)	Notes / Suggestions
Jacob	Praised the fluidity of AR transitions but noted the interface could be simpler.	Suggested clearer icons for interaction.
Jason	Said the AR made the museum “feel alive” and increased curiosity to explore more.	Recommended shorter text pop-ups for quick reading.
Eamma	Enjoyed the visual storytelling; felt AR helped connect history with learning.	Suggested adding light sound or narration.
Jasmine	Found the AR engaging and said it “brings the objects to life.”	Proposed larger hotspots for easier touch response.
Eva	Liked the added context from AR layers; said it made exhibits easier to understand.	“If students could design part of it, that would make it feel alive.”

Figure 19. Summary of prototype testing

Overall, the prototype testing produced positive results. All participants responded well to the AR-enhanced experience, describing it as more engaging, informative, and emotionally connected than the original static display. The emoji feedback indicated curiosity and enjoyment across most interaction points. Participants agreed that digital overlays helped clarify information and made the museum “feel alive.”
Common suggestions focused on improving usability and clarity—including simplifying the interface, enlarging touch areas, and adding clearer visual or audio cues to guide interaction. These insights demonstrate that even low-cost media interventions can significantly enhance visitor engagement, supporting the idea that mediatisation can revitalise traditional exhibitions through accessibility and emotional connection.

4. Future Research

In the next phase, this project will continue refining the AR guidebook prototype as a practical and low-cost tool for revitalising the Monash Computer History Museum. The future development will focus on improving usability, enriching narrative layers, and testing additional media features such as projection mapping, spatial sound, and user-contributed stories.

These enhancements aim to evaluate how digital interventions can enhance accessibility and participation without large-scale physical renovation—supporting what Hooper-Greenhill (2000) describes as the interpretive turn in museums, where meaning is produced through communication rather than static display.

Figure 20. Prototype display

Beyond this specific case, I hope to further investigate the use of media facilities as a transitional renovation method for small-scale museums. This approach allows media to act as a connective layer between historical artefacts and contemporary audiences, transforming museums into spaces of interaction and emotional engagement. As Falk and Dierking (2016) suggest, visitor experience emerges from the dynamic relationship between personal, physical, and sociocultural contexts—a balance that media technologies can help reframe. Similarly, Manzini (2015) emphasises design for social innovation as a way to improve systems through small, distributed, and sustainable actions. Applying this logic, media-based renovation becomes not an act of replacement but an act of reconnection—where digital storytelling revitalises heritage through visibility, empathy, and shared meaning.

5.Self-Reflection

Through this project, I learned that mediatisation is not only about technology but about connection — between people, space, and meaning. Observing how students interacted with the museum taught me that design begins with awareness, not tools. Even small interventions, such as an AR guidebook, can change how people perceive and engage with a space.
Working through each research stage — from field observation to prototype testing — helped me understand how qualitative data can lead to concrete design actions. The interviews and surveys reminded me that visibility is built through communication, not complexity. The process also showed that co-creation and empathy are essential to transforming traditional exhibitions into living, participatory experiences.
I believe using AR as a transitional renovation method provides a practical way to revitalise museums without large-scale changes. It allows media to serve as a bridge, making history visible, interactive, and emotionally engaging. This project strengthened my confidence in combining research and design thinking, and it inspired me to continue exploring how digital storytelling can reconnect people with cultural spaces.

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Generative AI Statement

Generative AI tools were used during this project to assist with language translation and text refinement.
Specifically, ChatGPT (OpenAI, 2025) was employed to help translate bilingual content between Chinese and English, ensuring linguistic accuracy and clarity.
In addition, the AI tool was used to enhance the narrative tone of written sections — making descriptive passages more coherent, engaging, and suitable for storytelling within the exhibition context.

Appendix A
— Interview Transcripts

1.Nearby study area Student

Q1: “It’s just convenient here, and my friends are always around. The library feels too formal.”
Q2: “Yeah, I’ve seen that glass area with old computers. I think that’s the museum, right?”
Q3: “I picture, like, vintage computers or old tech. It’s kind of cool but… maybe boring if it’s just objects.”
Q4: “I’ve looked through the glass once. It didn’t seem like there was much to do.”
Q5: “It looks neat but static. I didn’t feel invited to go in—it’s like watching something behind glass.”
Q6: “Usually Instagram or student newsletters.”
Q7: “Maybe events or student exhibitions inside the museum could make it interesting.”
Q8: “Screens, lights, maybe something interactive that reacts when you walk by.”
Q9: “If students could design part of it, that would make it feel more alive.”
Q10: “A museum should feel like part of the campus life, not just decoration.”

Q1: It’s just quieter here than the library. The library’s always crowded, and here I can sit with friends or plug in my laptop easily.
Q2: Museum? Oh… really? I didn’t know there’s one here. I thought that room was for storage or something.
Q3: Maybe old computers? Like, big grey boxes or something from the 90s?
Q4: No, honestly, I never noticed it. Maybe it doesn’t look open or something.
Q5: Can’t really say… I didn’t know it existed.
Q6: Mostly Instagram or Monash emails. Posters don’t really work for me.
Q7: If it was more visible, or had something interactive—like a cool display or AR thing.
Q8: Maybe a short video or an interactive screen that shows how computers evolved. Something visual.
Q9: Yeah, that could be fun—like students showing their old devices or memories of early tech.
Q10: It should connect to what students study now, not just show old stuff. Maybe make tech history relevant again.

Q1: “I like the space here because it’s bright and near the café.”
Q2: “Yes, I know there’s a small museum there.”
Q3: “I expected something like computer evolution stories or games.”
Q4: “I went in once during a break. It’s mostly old machines behind glass—no interaction.”
Q5: “It’s not easy to understand what’s special about those items, no context.”
Q6: “Mostly from Moodle announcements or social media.”
Q7: “Add stories—like how those computers were used at Monash or by students.”
Q8: “Maybe an AR overlay that shows them working, or a digital timeline.”
Q9: “Yes! I’d love to record something about how we use tech now and compare it.”
Q10: “It should bridge the past and present—make students feel connected to history.”

Appendix A
— Interview Transcripts

Q1: “I prefer studying here because it feels more casual than the library.”
Q2: “I’ve seen the museum through the windows, yeah.”
Q3: “Honestly, I think of it as something old-fashioned.”
Q4: “I looked once. It’s fine but very outdated—just objects and text panels.”
Q5: “The space isn’t inviting. It feels closed off, like a display case.”
Q6: “If Monash posts on Instagram, I usually check.”
Q7: “Make it more interactive, or connect it to student life.”
Q8: “AR, touch screens, or sound-based exhibits would make it cool.”
Q9: “I’d like to if it was easy—like uploading a short video or memory.”
Q10: “It should make students feel part of Monash’s story, not just show old stuff.”

2. Art Background Student

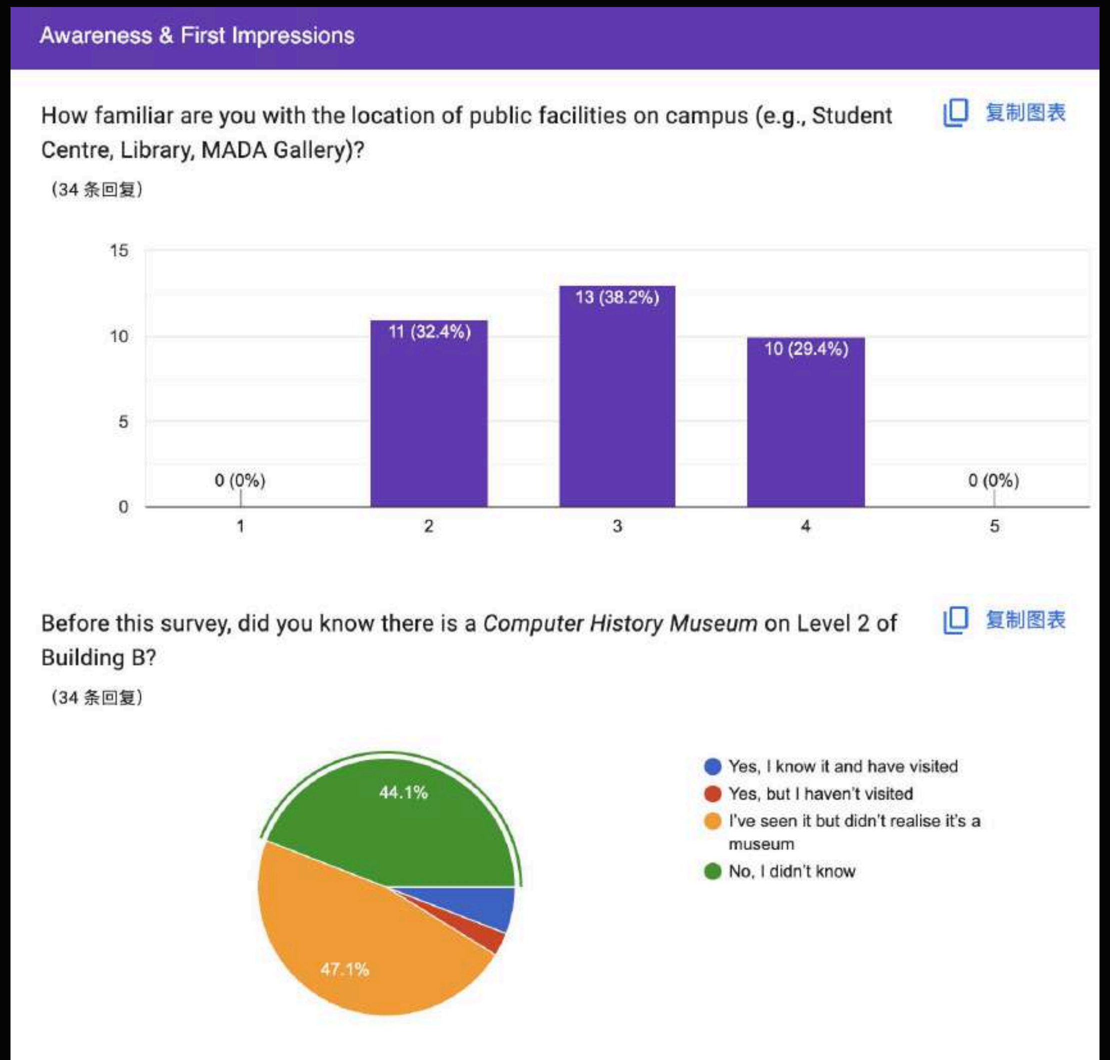
Q1: I often work here because the environment is casual and connected to our studio spaces. I also observe how people interact—or don’t interact—with the museum. It’s useful for our heritage design assignment.
Q2: The museum is right there, but it’s visually disconnected from the rest of the area. People walk past it without realising it’s an exhibition space.
Q3: Ideally, it should tell a narrative about the evolution of technology and Monash’s own computing legacy. But currently, it functions more like a storage display—it lacks mediation and storytelling.
Q4: The artefacts are interesting historically, but the experience is quite flat. There’s no contextual information or multisensory engagement—no sound, no interaction, no digital layer.
Q5: The layout feels enclosed, with no clear circulation or focal point. The design doesn’t communicate openness or curiosity.
Q6: I usually learn about exhibitions through faculty channels or Instagram, but the museum isn’t active online.
Q7: If it included co-curated digital projects or participatory installations, I’d visit more often. Students could contribute stories about how technology affects their studies—it would make the museum more alive.
Q8: Screens could host short rotating exhibitions curated by students, AR could visualise how those old machines worked, and social media could share student-made content or behind-the-scenes stories.
Q9: Yes, absolutely. That’s part of what we’re exploring in class—how digital storytelling can turn a passive viewer into a participant.
Q10: It should be a living cultural lab—a site for co-creation and reflection on the university’s technological and social identity.

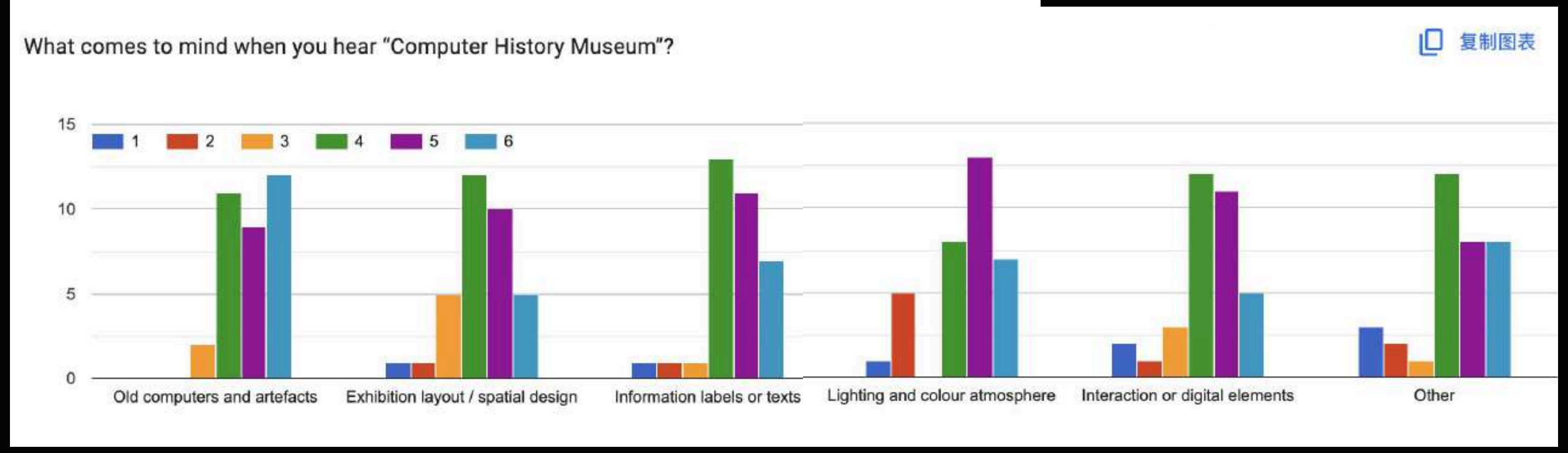
Q1: I like the openness here, but it’s ironic—people are surrounded by cultural material and don’t even see it. It says a lot about the museum’s visibility problem.
Q2: The signage, lighting, and spatial boundaries are confusing—it’s unclear where the museum starts or ends.
Q3: I think of a hybrid between an archive and an experience space—something that connects technical history with contemporary design culture.
Q4: The current display is static and emotionless. The vitrines dominate the space, leaving no narrative or visitor journey.
Q5: There’s no entry gesture, no digital interface, and the lighting makes it feel closed. Many people aren’t even sure if they’re allowed to go in.
Q6: I usually find out about campus exhibitions through MADA newsletters or Monash social media, but I’ve never seen this museum mentioned there.
Q7: If it became interactive—allowing visitors to manipulate digital models or contribute to an evolving database—it would be much more engaging.
Q8: Digital media can bridge the gap between archive and experience. For instance, AR could show how early computing interfaces worked, or screens could enable real-time student interaction.
Q9: Definitely. Participatory content creation should be part of its redesign—it’s how the museum can reflect living culture.
Q10: The museum should serve as a communicative bridge between academic knowledge and everyday culture, mediating memory, identity, and innovation.

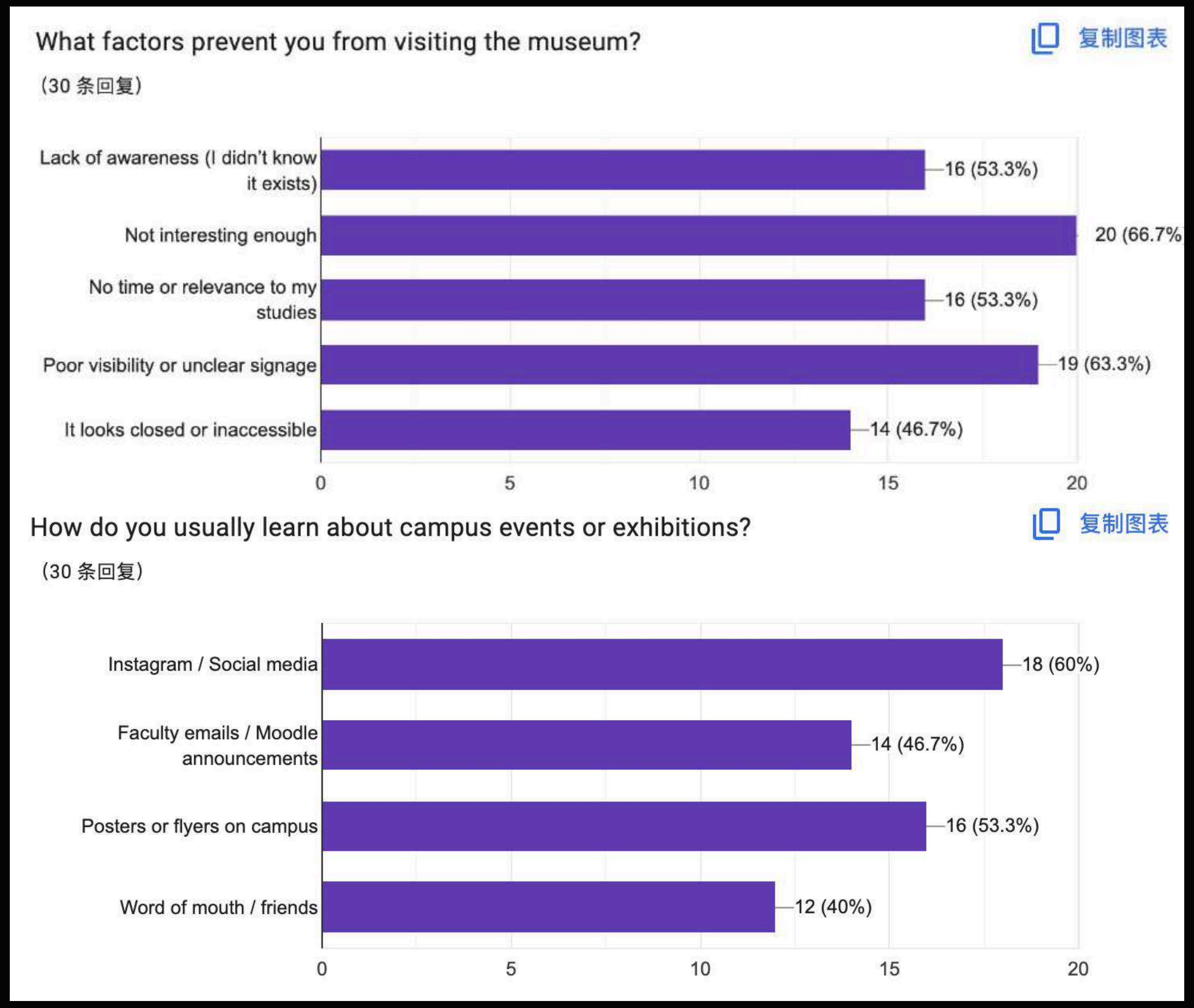
Appendix A
— Interview Transcripts

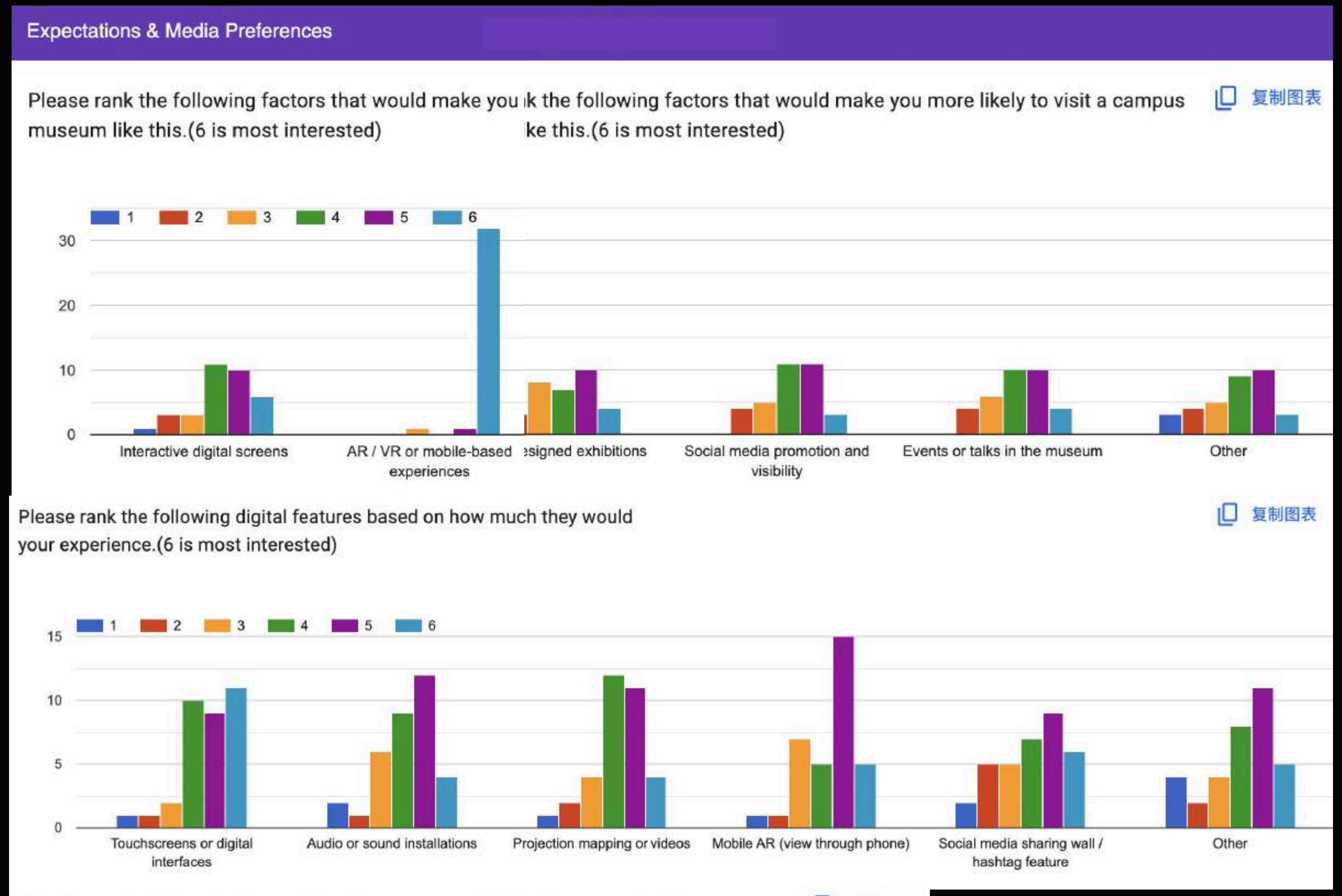
Q1: Because most of my classes are in Building B, it's convenient to stay here after class.
Q2: I only go to Building B for lectures. I don't really like it—it feels oppressive, especially that elevator. I honestly had no idea there was a museum nearby.
Q3: I think "Computer History Museum" literally means a museum about computer history, but I'm not particularly interested in that topic.
Q4: I've passed by and looked inside once. Some of the old computers are interesting, but the overall curatorial style and visual presentation are outdated. Without seeing the machines, I wouldn't even associate the space with a museum of computer history.
Q5: I didn't feel welcomed—it's very cold and closed off. Everything is behind glass, so there's no real sensory engagement. It's also not accessible for visitors with visual impairments. The display is purely visual and difficult to connect with emotionally. The information panels don't draw attention either; they're too static.
Q6: I usually learn about campus events from MONSU and MGA newsletters—they send weekly updates that I sometimes check. Occasionally, I notice posters or display boards on campus that help me learn about events.
Q7: First, the museum's entire visual identity needs rebranding—it's disconnected from its concept. The exhibition should be multisensory and inclusive, allowing visitors of different abilities to have a fair experience. For example, adding audio descriptions for visual pieces could help both sighted and visually impaired visitors better understand the objects. Some exhibits should also be touchable—feeling the texture and material could make the experience memorable. People know what an early Apple computer looks like, but how does it feel? That would be meaningful.
Q8: Digital media could help, but it shouldn't dominate. Digital screens still rely heavily on vision, which can be exclusionary for some visitors. The experience should not be limited to visual interaction only.
Q9: Honestly, I wouldn't be interested in contributing my own story. The museum doesn't attract me enough to participate.
Q10: I think the museum should give students more opportunities to participate—like letting them curate or exhibit their own work. That would make it feel more relevant and alive.

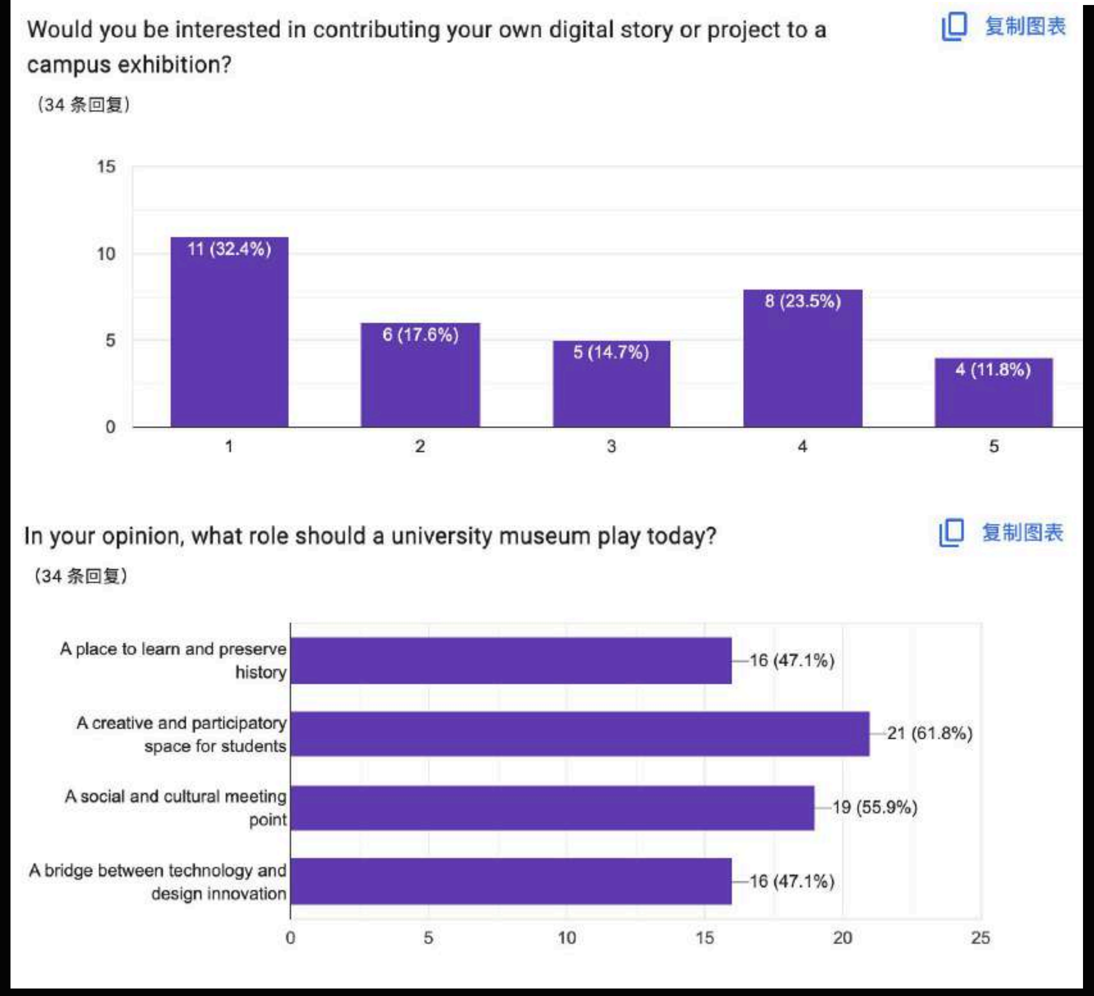
Appendix B
— Questionnaire Results





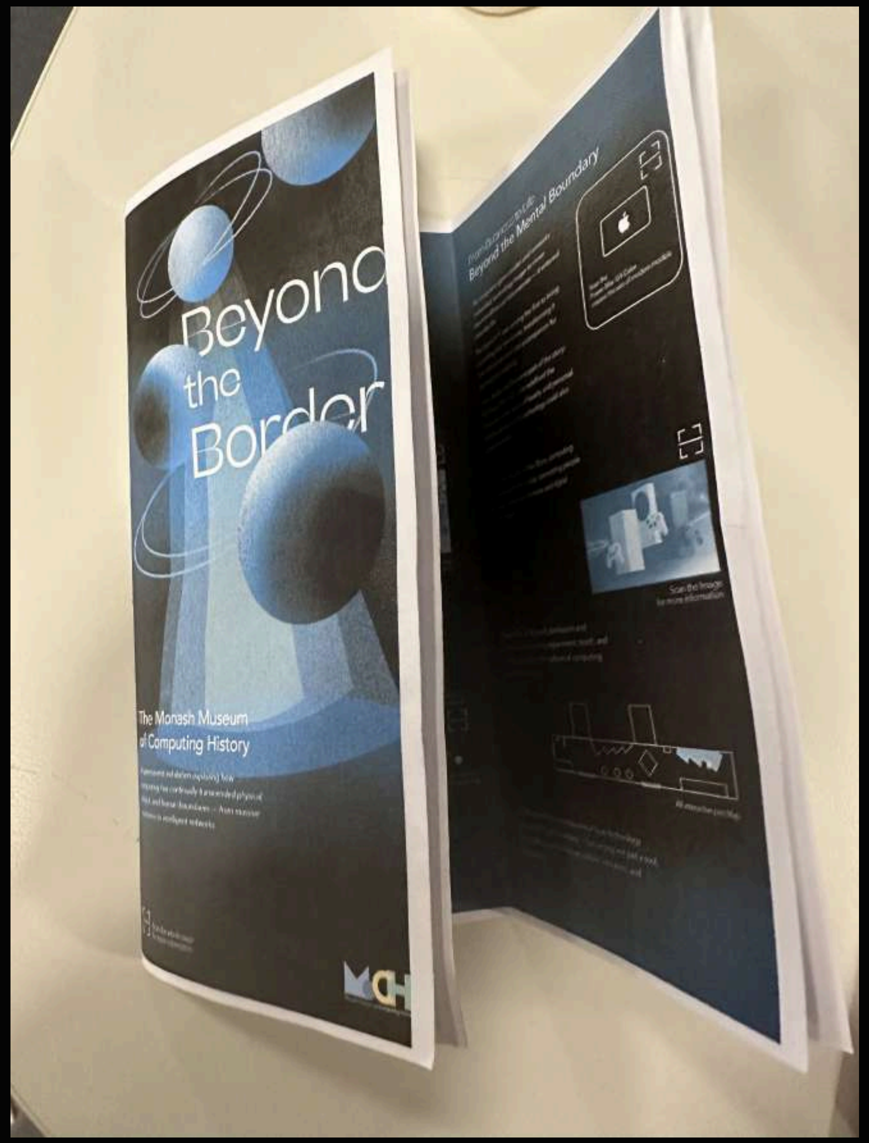
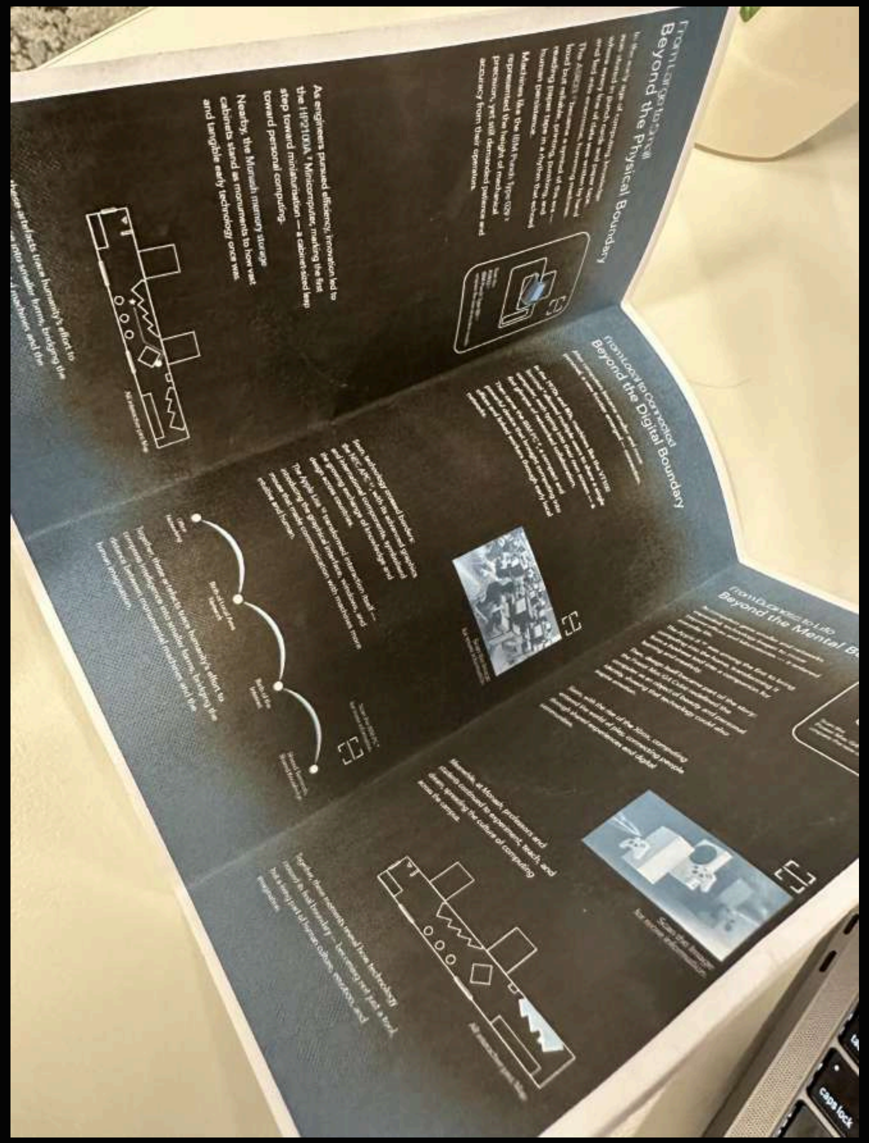
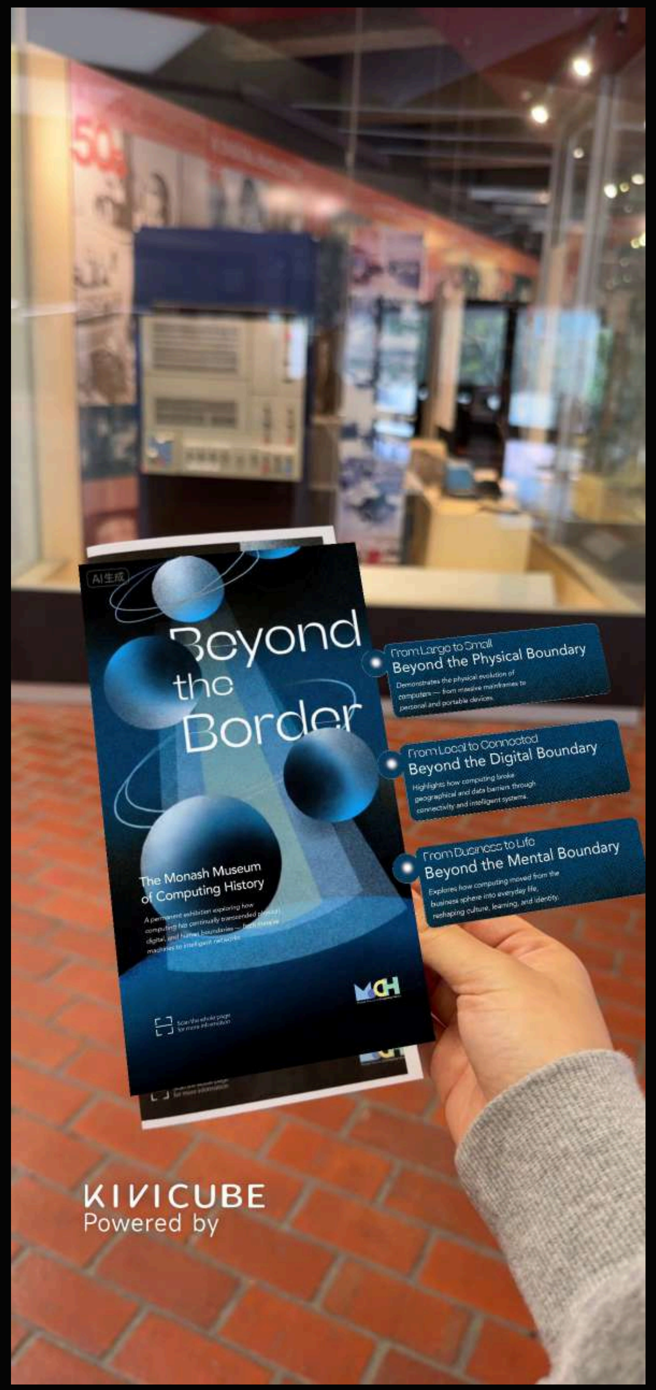


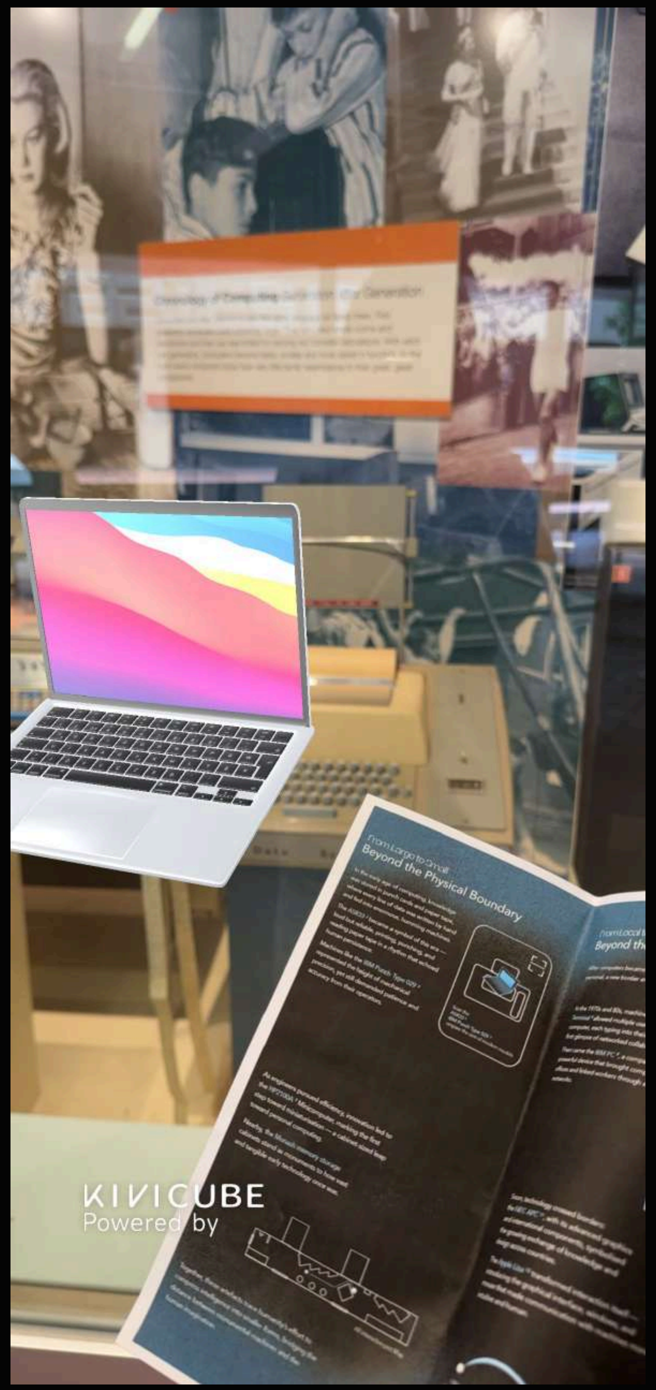


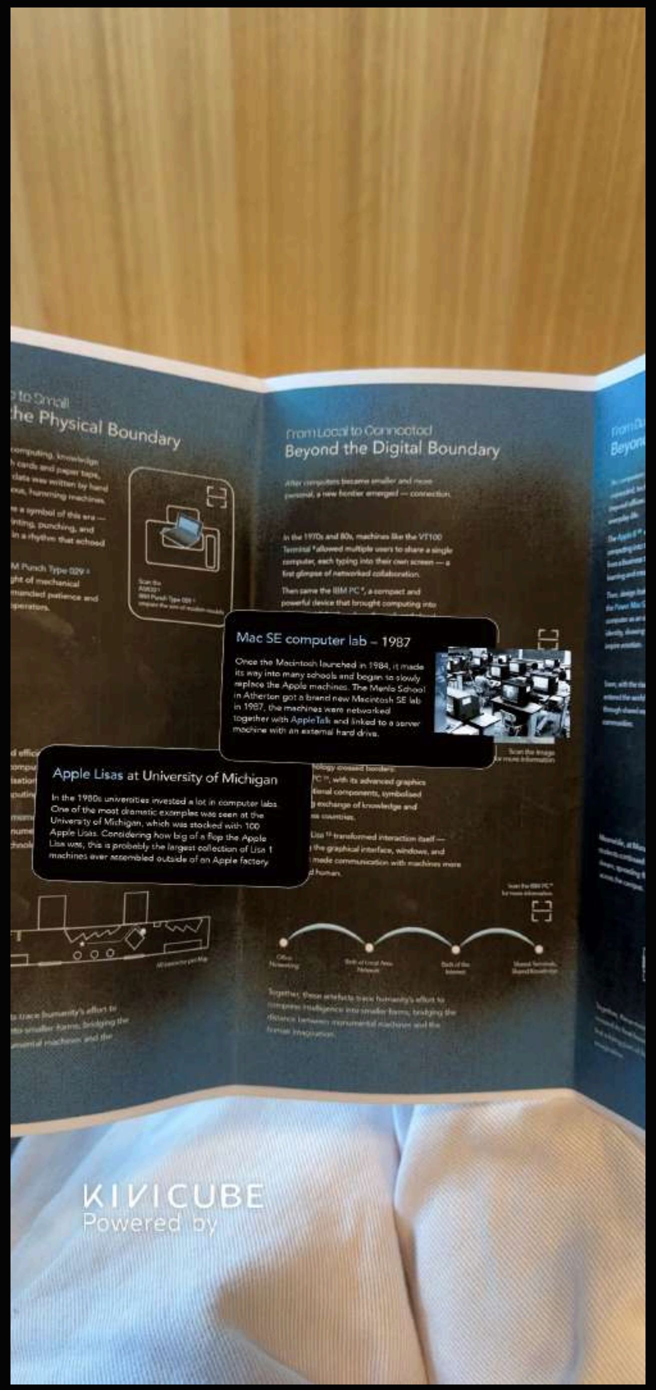


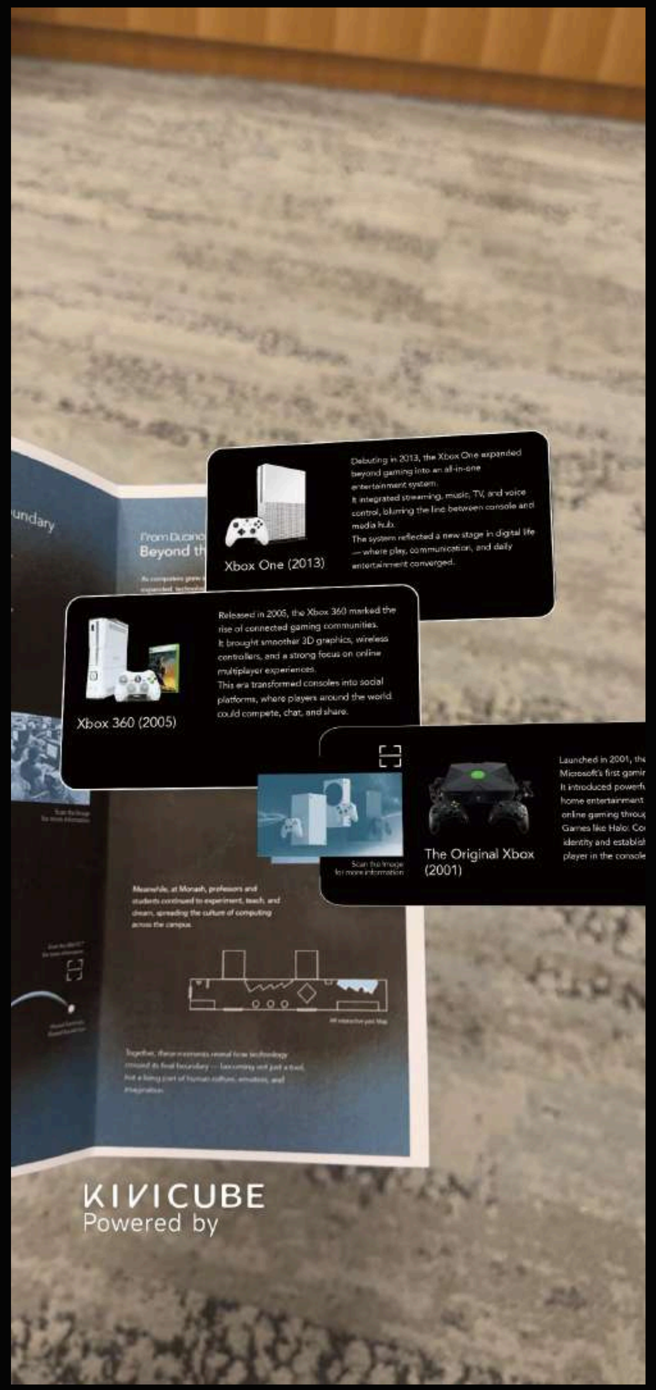
Appendix C
— Prototype Testing

Prototype and Testing







Appendix D
— Visual Documentation